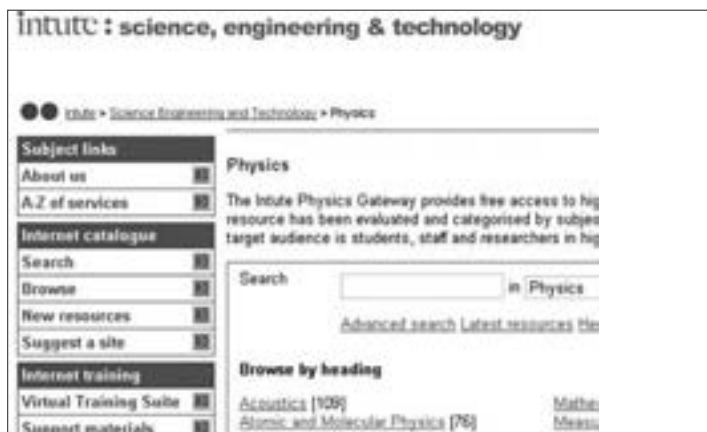




The Intute Physics Gateway

provided about the sites, so it is not possible for a visitor to know which site is most popular or the largest among those listed.

A search box makes it much easier to identify the relevant Web sites, but the search is limited to the content of the site description rather than the sites themselves. Intute tries to rectify this situation by using what it calls a “Harvester,” a software that takes a sample of pages—which can go up to 100 pages—from each site and indexes them. It is possible that the terms that do not exist in the description may occur in the Web sites, and Harvester offers the opportunity, albeit limited, to improve the chances of finding the relevant sites.

An alternative way to use the Web site is through the “Subject Packs,” where Intute has organised the links to suit the educational requirements of student courses. The subject packs link is available on the right side bar. Besides physics, subject packs exist for chemistry and geography. Under the Physics Subject Pack the following topics are covered: Basic electricity, Capacitors and capacitance, Circular motion, Fundamental particles, Kinematics, Radioactivity, Relativity, and Vectors. As can be noticed, the coverage of topics is not as wide as at most sites on the subject. In this listing, the site description clearly mentions whether the site con-